

Ethics

Part 1





About the Course

One of Mason's main pillars is that the student is born a "person." *Ourselves* is the book in which she defines that term, and it is the only volume she wrote directly to students. The book is divided into two parts. We use *Ourselves* Part 1 in Grades 7-9 and Part 2 in Grades 10-11, as Mason did in her own schools. In these books, students will explore characteristics shared by all Image-Bearers and learn how to guard against good servants becoming bad masters with Charlotte Mason's text written directly to students.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.), Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)



Placement & Combining Tips

Ourselves by Charlotte Mason is scheduled over five years. In a multi-age context, students can jump into the book wherever the class is reading. Otherwise, students should begin the book in Part 1.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7+	Ethics: Part 1 1 time/week 25 min	<i>Ourselves</i> : Book 1

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)				
Ethics: Part 1 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		American Government: Grade 7		Plutarch: Grades 6-8 Current Events: Grades 5-8
Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)				
Ethics: Part 1 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Canadian Government: Grade 7		Plutarch: Grades 6-8 Current Events: Grades 5-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (U.S.)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Ethics: Part 1



Ourselves: Book 1



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

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Ethics: Part 1

How To Teach



Prepare

Plutarch: Teachers will find it helpful to preread the entire Life first, and then preread the day's passage before each lesson. Mark any passages that should be omitted due to content. (In Anne White's Plutarch Project books, the recommended source for this course, objectionable content has already been omitted.)

Current Events: Preview the news source for suitability.

Most other citizenship topics don't require additional prep.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources, show students how to scan the headlines to get an overview first and then choose a story to read.

For Plutarch or other books: Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story as relevant. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves* and Plutarch, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, and/or Commonplace book.



Narrate

Have the students narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions to help students discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Have students record important ideas in their Citizenship Notebooks.

Ethics: Part 1

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Term 1

WEEK 1 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 1

Country of Mansoul

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Charlotte Mason, the author of this text, felt that the available material on formal formation during her time was severely lacking; what was available she considered unsuitably preachy and uninteresting. She felt compelled to write an approachable but challenging alternative, which is the text for this course: Ourselves.

Mason believed that before we could fully consider our duties to God, country, and others, we must first know and begin to understand ourselves, including the possibilities and risks inherent in all of us. Self-knowledge, in her view, was the inevitable prerequisite to self-direction, which is why she aptly named the first and second "Books" of Ourselves after each.

In order to present these ideas in an interesting way, she used the allegory of a country and its government. In her own words: "The realised self of each of us is a distressfully poor thing, and yet upon its insight and its action depends the redemption of that greater self, whose limitations no man has discovered. It is, to use a figure, as the relation between a country and its government. The country is ever greater than the governing body; and yet, for its development, the former must depend upon the latter."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.I p.1-2 "Do ye not" - "be a hero."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Begin drawing a map of Mansoul using information from today's reading.

• DEFINITIONS

londes: an old English word for lands

WEEK 2 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 2

Country of Mansoul

Materials: Ourselves

→ RECAP

In the last lesson, we were introduced to the country of Mansoul. How would you describe it in your own words?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.I p.3-4 "There are libraries" - "rich and beautiful."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Continue work on map of Mansoul.

• DEFINITIONS

cricket: a bat and ball game that originated and is popular in England

• COMPOSITION

How is Mansoul like a rich and beautiful land?

WEEK 3 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 3

Perils of Mansoul

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What do you remember about the culture of Mansoul from our last reading? How is it similar to where you live? How is it different?

Today, we will begin a new chapter called The Perils of Mansoul. A peril is a serious or immediate danger. Let's see what dangers are lurking for Mansoul.

• DEFINITIONS

incendiary: a device or strategy intended to start a fire

Föhn: a strong, warm air that comes down off the Alps and is known to both melt snow and spread wildfires

• COMPOSITION

What are ways a flame could come from a foreign land?

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Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.II p.5-6 "You are thinking" - "fires and lights."

WEEK 4 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 4

Perils of Mansoul

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What perils put the country of Mansoul at risk? How? What, if anything, could be done to prevent them?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.II p.6-8 "Sometimes there is" - "to its duties."

• DEFINITIONS

ministry: a specific department within the government

Prime Minister: the head of the British government

• COMPOSITION

Tell about some of the Perils of Mansoul and tell which are the most perilous for you.

WEEK 5 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 5

Government of Mansoul

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

In the last lesson, we read about several more perils to Mansoul: Plague, Flood, Famine, Discord, and Darkness. What causes these perils, and what are some of the consequences?

Today, we will be introduced to the government of Mansoul. In the same way that every country must have a form of government, so, too, must a person have an internal "government" that rules them.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.III p.9-10 "I must give" - "a human being."

• DEFINITIONS

esquire: similar to a page, a lower servant or assistant to a higher government office

lord: the formal title for a ruler over a particular land or territory

exchequer /eks CHEK er/: the name of the British government department responsible for the collection and management of taxes and revenue; similar to a Treasury

minister: the head of a specific department (ministry) within the government

WEEK 6 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 6

Esquires of the Body: Hunger

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What do you remember about the government of Mansoul? Why is it important to understand these powers within a person?

In today's reading, you'll hear the word esquire. In Mason's time, an esquire was often one who received a title (such as "lord") for service to the king. Sometimes they worked for the good of the kingdom, but other times to gain an advantage over others. How would that affect the kingdom? In this book, Mason gives the name "esquire" to the appetites of the body. As we read, keep this in mind.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.I p.11-13 "We will first" - "two hours long."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Start a chart of the government of Mansoul that includes the King, the Prime Minister, and the Esquires. As you read, tell what their duties are and how each has the potential to damage the kingdom of Mansoul when they try to become too powerful.

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Term 1

WEEK 7 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 7

Esquires of the Body: Hunger

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What is meant by "Esquires of the Body"? Describe in your own words.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.I p.13-14 "But, you will say" - "his good tidings."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Continue adding to government chart.

• DEFINITIONS

pudding: dessert

hampers: packages of food

• COMPOSITION

How is hunger both a servant and a master?

WEEK 8 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 8

Esquires of the Body: Thirst

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

According to our last lesson, how are we to avoid Greediness? Why is it important to do so?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.II p.15-17 "Another most serviceable" - "delicious it is."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Continue adding to government chart.

• DEFINITIONS

forms: the structure of the British school system, similar to grades

WEEK 9 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 9

Esquires: Restlessness and Rest

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe what you remember about Thirst. How can Thirst be a source of danger for Mansoul?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.III p.18-20 "I hardly know" - "work or play."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Continue adding to government chart.

• DEFINITIONS

daemon: As Mason uses it here, it refers to the cruel, evil, and/or destructive manifestation of a quality or trait.

• COMPOSITION

Describe sloth and what its outcome can be in the body.

WEEK 10 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 10

Esquires of the Body: Chastity

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

How can restlessness be helpful? How can rest be helpful? How can each be destructive?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.IV p.21-23 "We have seen" - "to do so."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Continue adding to government chart.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please note the sensitive content in this section that talks about chastity.

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Term 1

WEEK 11  25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 11 <i>Catch-Up Day</i> → CATCH-UP Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.	
WEEK 12  25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 12 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Ourselves	

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Term 2

WEEK 1 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 13

Pages of the Body: Five Senses

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Last term, we read about the government of Mansoul. Describe what you remember about its King, its Prime Minister, and its Esquires.

Today, we will read about "Pages." These are the assistants, or servants, to the Esquires.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.V p.24-26 "The Esquires" - "fresh or fusty"

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Start a list for each Page and their duties.

• COMPOSITION

Tell how to keep Smell "in good working order."

WEEK 2 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 14

Pages of the Body: Five Senses

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe how Taste is a useful Page to the body. What happens when we pamper it?

Why is Smell described as lazy?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.V p.26-28 "There are five" - "cause of the pain."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Continue adding to lists on Pages.

• DEFINITIONS

Spartan boy: This refers to a story from Sparta where a young boy caught a live fox and hid it in his robes. The fox began to bite and claw him, but the boy was determined to show bravery and refused to move or ask for help until he died from his wounds.

WEEK 3 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 15

Pages of the Body: Five Senses

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe how Touch is a good servant to the body, but a bad master.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.V p.28-30 "But, on the other" - "can distinguish."

• CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Continue adding to lists on Pages.

• DEFINITIONS

mustard poultice: a paste often used to treat chest congestion in Mason's time. If left too long, it can irritate the skin.

drawing room: similar to a living room

James Simpson: a Scottish doctor who first used chloroform as an anesthetic

• COMPOSITION

"Do you know how Eyes and No-Eyes went out for a walk?" Tell what followed in the reading.

WEEK 4 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 16

Pages of the Body: Five Senses

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What did Mason mean by it is "good to have little things to put up with?"

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.I Ch.V p.30-32 "Then, as you" - "whom he knows!"

• DEFINITIONS

tunes: popular songs of the day

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Term 2

- CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK
Continue adding to lists on Pages.

WEEK 5 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 17

Ourselves

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

How are Sight and Hearing sources of joy? Explain the statement, "The more we listen, the more we hear."

Today, we will begin a new part of our book. We will be reading about all of the parts that comprise our whole selves: our bodies, minds, hearts, and souls.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.I p.33-34 "When we think" - "the Government."

- CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK
Create a chart with four columns labeled Body, Mind, Heart, and Soul. Record important ideas in the appropriate column after each reading.

WEEK 6 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 18

My Lord Intellect

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Why is it important to understand our "inner" selves? Explain the differences between Self-Control, Self-Knowledge, and Self-Reverence.

Today, we will read about a new member of the government, the Lord Intellect (equivalent to the Foreign Secretary in the U.K., the Secretary of State in the U.S., or the Minister of Foreign Affairs in Canada). This official's role is to talk with representatives from other countries and work out problems peacefully.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.II p.35-37 "To begin with" - "King had gone."

- CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK
Add the Foreign Secretary to chart of government officials started in Lesson 6.

• DEFINITIONS

kinetoscope: a type of early motion picture device designed for one person

WEEK 7 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 19

My Lord Intellect

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Why is Intellect given the title the "Foreign Secretary" of Mansoul? Describe his job duties.

Today, we will read about Philosophy, which is the study of knowledge and reality. How do you know something is true?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.II p.37-39 "We see, too" - "ease for Mansoul."

• COMPOSITION

Explain how Imagination can be a good companion in travels OR Tell about the land of Mathematics.

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Term 2

WEEK 8 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 20

My Lord Intellect

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe what you remember about the domains of History, Mathematics, and Philosophy.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.II p.39-41 "Perhaps the least" - "by this test."

WEEK 9 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 21

My Lord Intellect

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe the Kingdom of Literature. How can we recognize Literature?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.II p.41-42 "There is another" - "ear or our eye."

• COMPOSITION

How is the Beauty Sense used well?

WEEK 10 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 22

My Lord Intellect

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Why does Intellect need the Beauty Sense as a second companion? What service does the Beauty Sense provide?

Today's reading uses the word "simulation." Do you know what a simulation is? [the imitation of a situation or a process]

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.II p.42-44 "But, like all" - "weary slave."

• DEFINITIONS

marks: the British word for grades

WEEK 11 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 23

Daemons of Intellect

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What do you remember about the Hall of Simulation? Why and how is it a threat to Mansoul?

Today, we will read about the Daemons of Intellect. (Daemon is an old spelling for demon.) A daemon in our reading is a force, decision, or habit that takes something God created to be good and twists it into something unhealthy.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.III p.45-47 "Like the Body" - "royal and magnanimous."

• DEFINITIONS

inertia: indisposition to motion, exertion, or change; the tendency to stay unmoving

jibs: to show hesitation or reluctance

coster's barrow: the wheelbarrow/cart of a fruit and vegetable seller

WEEK 12 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

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Term 2

Questions will come from:
Ourselves

Ethics: Part 1

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Term 3

WEEK 1 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 25

My Lord Chief Explorer, Imagination

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Last term, we finished with a discussion about the Daemons of Intellect. Why is Habit considered one of these Daemons? What does it mean to have a Magnanimous Mind?

We will start our new term by learning more about the Lord Chief Explorer of Mansoul, Imagination. What do you recall about him from last term?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.IV p.48-51 "My Lord Chief" - "kind meantime!"

• DEFINITIONS

spinney: a small thatch of bushes or trees

fjord: a long, narrow sea inlet with steep sides or cliffs, created by a glacier

Sir Walter Scott: a Scottish novelist, poet, and playwright, and one of Mason's personal favorites

• COMPOSITION

When is Imagination a good servant? What does it act like when it is directed at Self?

WEEK 2 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 26

My Lord Chief Explorer, Imagination

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

In our last lesson, we had a more thorough introduction to Imagination. Why is Imagination important? Describe how it can be used unlawfully.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.IV p.51-53 "But the others" - "in your thoughts."

WEEK 3 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 27

The Beauty Sense

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe how to combat the Daemon of Self in regards to Imagination from our last lesson. Why must we take care to guard our imagination from unclean or horrible thoughts?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.V p.54-55 "The Beauty Sense" - "terror for us."

WEEK 4 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 28

Lord Chief Attorney-General, Reason

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What do you recall from our last lesson about the Beauty Sense? How can we keep it in its right place?

Today, we will delve into a more thorough discussion of the Lord Chief Attorney-General of Mansoul: Reason. An attorney general is a position that usually serves as the main legal advisor to the government.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.VI p.56-58 "I have spoken" - "secretly entertained."

• DEFINITIONS

K.C.: the King's Counsel

The Tempest: a famous play by William Shakespeare in which a Duke named Prospero is set adrift to die by his brother, Antonio. Prospero shirked his responsibility as Duke in pursuit of the knowledge of magic and philosophy.

• COMPOSITION

Describe Reason.

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Term 3

WEEK 5 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 29

Lord Chief Attorney-General, Reason

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe what you remember about how Reason behaves from our last lesson. Why do you think it is described as an attorney?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.VI p.58-60 "The good man's" - "long ago settled."

• DEFINITIONS

John Howard: the first reformer of the British prison system

WEEK 6 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 30

Lord Chief Attorney-General, Reason

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What do you remember about how a good man's Reason operates? Why is Reason important for invention and innovation?

Today, we will hear about what happens when Reason is viewed as the highest possible aim.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.VI p.60-62 "It is very" - "the reasoning begins."

• COMPOSITION

Give some examples of Reason working its way out in your life or in your community.

WEEK 7 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 31

Lord Chief Attorney-General, Reason

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe the dangers of viewing Reason as infallible. How are two sensible people able to come to equally good but opposing conclusions on the same subject?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.VI p.62-65 "We have all been" - "anything they see."

WEEK 8 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 32

Lords of the Exchequer, The Desires

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

Describe the relationship between Reason and the Will from our last lesson.

Today, we will explore the Desires, which Mason refers to as the Lords of the Exchequer. The Exchequer is a British name for the government department responsible for the oversight and collection of revenue; in other words, the Treasury.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.VII p.66-68 "We consider" - "duly balanced."

• DEFINITIONS

approbation: approval

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Term 3

WEEK 9 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 33

Lords of the Exchequer, The Desires

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What do you recall from our last lesson about how the natural desire for approval can serve us? How can it become the Daemons of Vanity and Fame?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.VII p.68-70 "Another Desire" - "spend his money."

• DEFINITIONS

on his mettle: being ready or forced to prove your ability

WEEK 10 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 34

Lords of the Exchequer, The Desires

Materials: Ourselves

→ INTRO

What do you remember about the Desire of Excelling from our last reading? What things are worthy (and unworthy) of our pursuit? Why?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pt.II Ch.VII p.70-72 "As before" - "for our own."

• DEFINITIONS

avarice: greed

• COMPOSITION

Describe some good and bad outcomes of Desire for Wealth or Power.

WEEK 11 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 35

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH-UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 12 25m Ethics: Part 1 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Ourselves

Ethics: Part 1

Examination

- Term 1** · Ourselves: Book I: Describe the work of two "Esquires of the Body" (appetites), and show that these Esquires must be servants, not masters, in Mansoul. OR Tell about some of the perils of Mansoul.
- Term 2** · Ourselves: Book I: Show that the sense of touch is a useful servant but a bad master. How may we get a "hearing ear?" Mention some sounds that you have enjoyed this term. OR How do the Beauty Sense and Imagination help assist Intellect in his travels?
- Term 3** · Ourselves: Book I: Tell that the Desires of (a) approbation, (b) wealth, and (c) power have their uses and their dangers. Give examples from books you have read, if possible. OR Describe the benefits of Reason, as well as the dangers of depending upon it.